



Sleep Hygiene

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What is Sleep Hygiene?

Sleep hygiene refers to a set of habits and practices that help promote consistent, uninterrupted, and restful sleep.

While medications may offer short-term relief, they can lead to dependency and interfere with natural sleep patterns. In contrast, healthy sleep habits provide long-lasting solutions to sleep difficulties.

 Talk to your healthcare provider about the best approach for you. Sleep hygiene can be used alongside medication or cognitive therapy—or on its own.

Top 15 Sleep Hygiene Tips

1.  **Be Consistent**
Go to bed and wake up at the same time every day—even on weekends.
2.  **Only Sleep When Sleepy**
Don't lie in bed unless you're truly tired and ready for sleep.
3.  **Can't Sleep? Get Up**
After 20+ minutes of wakefulness, get up and do something calming in dim lighting—then return to bed when sleepy again.
4.  **Avoid Caffeine & Nicotine**
Cut out stimulants like coffee, tea, chocolate, cola, and cigarettes 4–6 hours before bedtime.
5.  **Avoid Alcohol**
While it may help you fall asleep initially, alcohol disrupts sleep quality later in the night.
6.  **Use Your Bed for Sleep Only**
Reserve your bed for sleep and intimacy—avoid TV, laptops, reading, or eating there.
7.  **Skip the Naps**
Naps reduce sleep pressure. If needed, limit naps to under 1 hour and before 3pm.

8. 🧘 **Develop a Sleep Ritual**
Establish a calming pre-bed routine—like light stretching, reading, or sipping herbal tea.
9. 🛁 **Take a Warm Bath**
A hot bath 1–2 hours before bed raises your body temp, which drops afterward to help induce sleep.
10. 🕒 **Ditch the Clock**
Constant clock-watching reinforces anxiety. Keep clocks out of sight during the night.
11. 📅 **Use a Sleep Diary (Short-Term)**
Track your sleep patterns for 1–2 weeks to spot trends—but don't do it long-term.
12. 🏃 **Exercise Regularly**
Physical activity promotes sleep, but avoid strenuous workouts within 4 hours of bedtime.
13. 🥗 **Eat Smart**
Avoid going to bed overly hungry or overly full. A light snack (like warm milk) can help.
14. 🌡️ **Create the Right Environment**
Cool, dark, and quiet works best. Use earplugs, blackout curtains, or an eye mask if needed.
15. 📅 **Stick to Your Day Plan**
Don't cancel daytime activities due to tiredness—it can reinforce insomnia patterns.